

Date and Oat Energy Balls (Variation 15)

Tags: snack, vegan, gluten-free, no-cook, meal-prep, healthy | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 0 min | Serves: 4

Ingredients

- 40 g Medjool dates, pitted
- 0.3 cups rolled oats
- 0.6 tbsp almond butter or peanut butter
- 0.4 tbsp honey or maple syrup
- 0.6 tbsp desiccated coconut
- 0.4 tbsp chia seeds
- 0.4 tbsp cacao powder
- 0.2 tsp vanilla extract
- 0.2/2 tsp cinnamon
- Pinch of sea salt
- Extra coconut, cacao nibs, or sesame seeds for rolling

Method

1. Place dates in a food processor and blend until a sticky paste forms.
2. Add oats, almond butter, honey, coconut, chia seeds, cacao powder, vanilla, cinnamon, and salt.
3. Pulse until the mixture comes together and holds its shape when squeezed.
4. If too dry, add honey or water 1 tsp at a time. If too wet, add oats.
5. Refrigerate the mixture for 20 minutes to firm up.
6. Roll tablespoon-sized portions between your palms into smooth balls.
7. Roll in desired coating — coconut, cacao nibs, or sesame seeds.
8. Store in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 2 weeks, or freeze for 3 months.

Chef Tips

- Medjool dates are far more moist and pliable than regular dried dates — use them for the best results.
- Chilling the mixture before rolling makes the balls hold together more easily.
- Customise freely — add protein powder, use different nut butters, or mix in dried cherries.